

Notification and Alert Settings

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Notification and Alert Settings

Overview

Effective notification management is essential for keeping users informed without overwhelming them. This article provides support agents with a deep dive into Nimbus notification types, configuration options, common issues, and escalation procedures. It also cross-references related articles such as **Account Access** and **Sharing Permissions**.

Notification Types

- **Email notifications** - sent for comments, shares, mentions, and storage warnings.
- **In-app alerts** - appear in the notification bell within the desktop and web clients.
- **Push notifications** - delivered to mobile devices for real-time updates.
- **Weekly digest** - a summary email sent every Monday.

Common Customer Symptoms

- Not receiving expected email alerts.
- Duplicate notifications for the same event.
- Missing push notifications on mobile.
- In-app notification bell not updating.
- Weekly digest not arriving.

Root Causes

Symptom	Typical Cause
No email alerts	Email address outdated, spam filter, notification toggle off
Duplicate alerts	Multiple subscription entries, overlapping folder mute settings
Missing push	OS-level permission disabled, battery-optimization killing background service
Stale in-app bell	Cache corruption, outdated client version
Digest missing	Digest toggle disabled, email delivery issues

Detailed Troubleshooting Steps

- **Verify User Preferences**

- Open Settings -> Notifications and confirm toggles for each event type.
- **Check Email Deliverability**
 - Ask the user to check spam/junk folders and whitelist `notifications@nimbus.com`.
 - Send a test email from the admin console.
- **Inspect Push Permission**
 - On iOS: Settings -> Nimbus -> Notifications -> Allow Notifications.
 - On Android: Settings -> Apps -> Nimbus -> Notifications -> Enable.
- **Review Folder Mute Settings**
 - Right-click a folder -> Mute notifications. Ensure the folder isn't unintentionally muted.
- **Clear In-App Notification Cache**
 - Desktop: Settings -> Advanced -> Clear Notification Cache.
 - Web: Log out, clear browser cache, and log back in.
- **Validate Weekly Digest Settings**
 - Settings -> Notifications -> Weekly Digest toggle.
 - Verify the user's email subscription status in the admin panel.
- **Examine Server Logs**
 - Look for `notification_send` errors in the backend logs for the user's ID.

Troubleshooting Tables

Email Notification Errors

Error Code	Meaning	Common Cause	Recommended Resolution
NOT-101	SMTP delivery failure	Invalid SMTP config or blocked port	Verify SMTP settings, ensure port 587 is open
NOT-204	Email bounced	Invalid recipient address or mailbox full	Confirm email address, ask user to clear mailbox

Push Notification Issues

Error Code	Meaning	Common Cause	Recommended Resolution
PUSH-301	Device token expired	User re-installed app or OS reset	Refresh device token by logging out/in
PUSH-402	Permission denied	OS notification permission disabled	Guide user to enable notifications in system settings

Examples and Edge Cases

- **Case 1:** User reports no email for comment notifications. Investigation shows the user disabled **Comments** toggle. Re-enable the toggle and send a test email.
- **Case 2:** Mobile push notifications stopped after a system update. The OS reset the app's background permissions; instruct user to allow "Background App Refresh".
- **Case 3:** Weekly digest missing for a user who disabled the digest but later re-enabled it. The change only takes effect after the next scheduled digest; inform the user to wait until Monday.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

- **Why am I receiving duplicate email notifications?** Duplicate alerts often occur when a folder is muted but the user also has a direct share on a file within that folder. Adjust mute settings or remove the direct share.
- **Can I customize which events trigger push notifications?** Currently, push notifications are enabled for all events. Users can disable push entirely via Settings -> Notifications -> Push.
- **How do I change the email address used for notifications?** Update the primary email in the account profile; notifications always use the primary email address.
- **Why is the in-app notification bell not updating?** Clear the notification cache (Settings -> Advanced -> Clear Notification Cache) and restart the client.
- **When should I escalate a notification issue?** Escalate if the user experiences missing critical alerts after all troubleshooting steps, or if server logs show repeated delivery failures.

Escalation Guidance

- **Trigger A:** Persistent email delivery failures (NOT-101 or NOT-204) after SMTP verification.
- **Trigger B:** Push notification failures on multiple devices for the same user.
- **Trigger C:** In-app notification bell remains stale despite cache clear and client restart.
- **Trigger D:** Weekly digest missing for more than two consecutive weeks.

Create a **Notification Escalation Ticket** with:

- User ID and device details.
- List of error codes observed.
- Steps taken and outcomes.
- Relevant server log excerpts.

Cross-Article References

- See **Account Access** for authentication-related notification failures.
- Refer to **Sharing Permissions** for notification behavior when folder or file sharing settings change.
- Consult **Error Code Reference** for detailed error meanings.

Support Notes (Internal)

- Known issue: On Android 13, the OS may throttle push notifications for apps not whitelisted for "Battery optimization". Recommend adding Nimbus to the whitelist.
- For large organizations, consider enabling the **Enterprise Notification Dashboard** for aggregated alert monitoring.
- Log all escalation tickets with notification log snapshots for future analysis.

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